STAFF GUIDE · ASSEMBLYMEMBER JESSE GABRIEL PRESS COVERAGE

Using the AJG Press Tracker

How to start the tracker on your PC, find and read coverage, keep the workbook up to date, and share it with colleagues.

What the tracker is

The tracker is a program on your PC that shows every news story about Assemblymember Gabriel: print, online, TV, radio, podcasts and non-English outlets. It runs inside a Microsoft Edge window (or your usual browser if Edge is not on the PC), but it is **not a website**. Everything it shows comes from files in one folder on your PC.

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The program stays on your PC

The tracker makes no internet connections and only reads and writes inside its own folder. One exception: newer saved copies show their photos from the news site, so Edge loads those pictures when you open such a copy. If the PC is offline, the text is still there; only those photos are missing.

ABOUT THE PICTURES

The screenshots come from a test copy of the tracker. Your counts, dates and fingerprints will be different.

BEFORE YOU START

Words used in this guide

Word	What it means
Workbook	The Excel file that holds every story, one row each. It is the master record. The tracker page is built from it.
Library	The folder of saved article copies (web pages and PDFs), sorted by year.
Saved copy	A copy of a story kept in the library, so it stays readable if the news site moves it or puts it behind a paywall.
Keeper	The one person who brings in new stories and saves them (currently Sammy). The keeper's copy is the official one.
Reader	Everyone else. A reader's copy is updated from the keeper's refresh files.
Fingerprint	A short code worked out from a file's exact contents, like `41315fe0`. If even one cell of the workbook changes, its fingerprint changes. The tracker uses it to know which workbook it is looking at.
"for Update" file	A small file the tracker makes that lists the stories it already has. The Update station needs it.
Update station	A separate page on claude.ai, run on the office's claude.ai account ajgdistrict@gmail.com, that searches for new stories and packs them into an update folder. See the companion guide, *Updating the tracker with the Update station*.
Update folder	A .zip file from the Update station with the new stories in it. (A .zip is one file that holds many files.)
Refresh file	A .zip the keeper makes after a save, so readers' copies can match.
Claude	The AI assistant (made by Anthropic) that reads and rates stories in the Update station, and that built and looks after the tracker program. "Send it to Claude" means paste it into the office's Claude conversation; ask the keeper.
TinyFish	The web-search service the Update station uses to find new stories. It appears in some update names.

START AND STOP

Starting and closing the tracker

1. **Open the tracker folder.** On the office PC it is `Desktop\AJG_v4\AJG Tracker`. Keep the folder on your own PC (for example on the Desktop), not on the shared drive: it does not run from there. Each person has their own copy.
2. **Double-click `Start Tracker.cmd`.** A black window opens. This window is the tracker's engine. **Leave it open** the whole time you use the tracker; you can minimize it.
3. **The tracker opens in its own Microsoft Edge window** (or your usual browser if Edge is not on the PC). It looks like a web page, but its address is `http://127.0.0.1:8765`, which means "this PC". Nothing goes out over the internet.

AJG Tracker (keep this window open)

```
AJG Tracker is running at http://127.0.0.1:8765/
Keep this window open while you use the tracker. Close it to stop the tracker.
```

What the black window says when the tracker has started. (A drawing made from the program's own messages.)

Closing the tracker

1. Close the Edge window.
2. Close the black window (click its X). This stops the tracker.

If you double-click `Start Tracker.cmd` while the tracker is already running, it just opens the page again.

On a Mac

The Mac copy works the same way, with the same buttons and files. The first time, unzip it with Terminal's own unzip and start it from Terminal: `cd ~/Desktop`, then `unzip ~/Downloads/"AJG Tracker Mac.zip"`, then `bash "AJG Tracker/Start Tracker.command"`. After that, double-click `Start Tracker.command`. If macOS says it cannot check the file, right-click it and choose Open, or use System Settings, Privacy & Security, Open Anyway. A Terminal window takes the place of the black window, and the tracker opens in your usual browser. To stop, close the Terminal window.

DON'T CLOSE THE BLACK WINDOW DURING A SAVE

Saving, making files and repairs all run in the black window. If you close it in the middle, the job stops. The tracker always backs up the workbook before it writes, so nothing is lost, but you will have to run the job again.

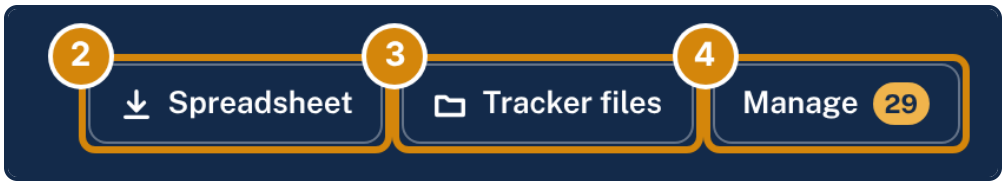
FIND YOUR WAY

The top of the page

The dark band at the top stays on screen wherever you are.



The top of the tracker. The numbers match the list below.



Close-up of the buttons at the top right: 2 Spreadsheet, 3 Tracker files, 4 Manage.

1. **Back and Forward.** Go back to the view you were on before, like a browser's back button.
2. **Spreadsheet.** Downloads a copy of the workbook (Excel) to your Downloads folder. Changing that copy does not change the tracker.
3. **Tracker files.** Opens the panel for updates, refresh files and repairs (page 21). An amber dot on it means something needs attention.
4. **Manage.** Opens the Update log, saved-copy counts, data checks and definitions (page 19). The number on it (29 in the picture) counts things worth a look, such as pages without a tone rating; it changes over time.
5. **Tabs.** Home, Clips, Data, Reporters, Outlets, Press releases, Bills and Story travel. Click one to switch.



After a save, a third line under "Press coverage tracker" says when the tracker was last updated.

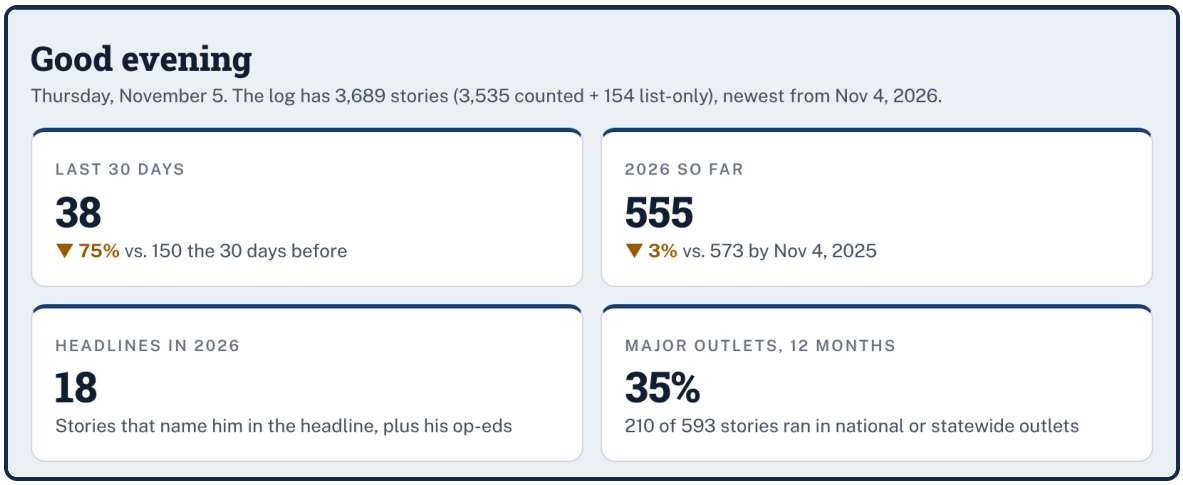
THE OLD PRESS DESK

If you used the old online tracker: its Press desk tools are now the Reporters, Outlets, Press releases, Bills and Story travel tabs. The Update database, tone, author and translation buttons are not in the PC tracker; that work happens in the Update station.

TAB 1

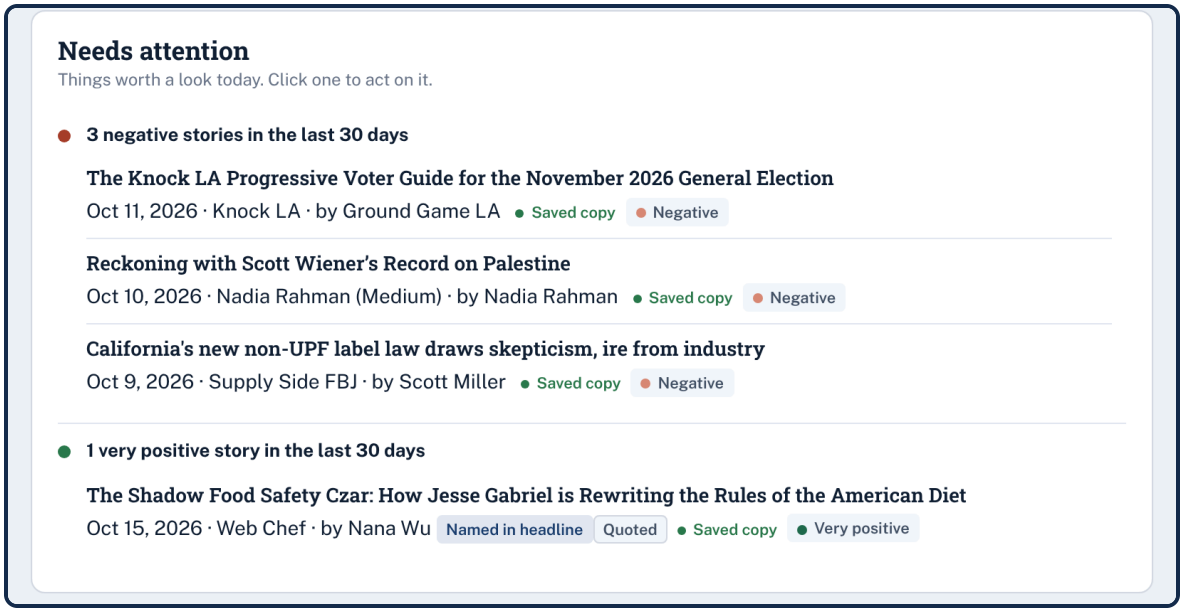
Home

Home is a quick summary of the coverage. Every part can be clicked to see the stories behind it.

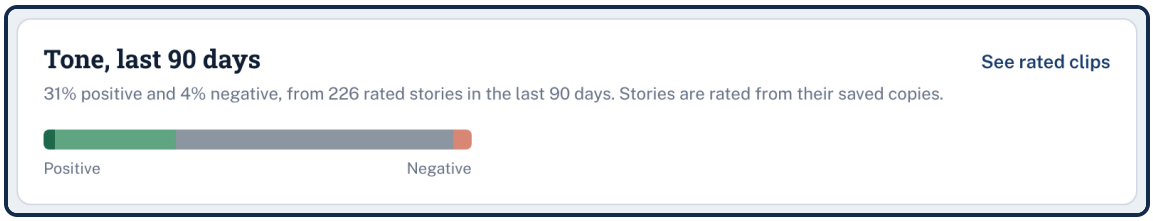


The top of Home: the greeting line and the four summary tiles. "▼ 75% vs. 150 the 30 days before" means 75% fewer stories than in the 30 days before.

- **The line under the greeting** gives the number of stories and the date of the newest one.
- **The four tiles** compare the last 30 days and this year with the same period before, and show headlines and major outlets. The arrow and percent show the change (an amber down arrow means fewer than before).
- **Needs attention** lists negative stories and very positive stories from the last 30 days. Click a headline to open the story.



"Needs attention", below the tiles.



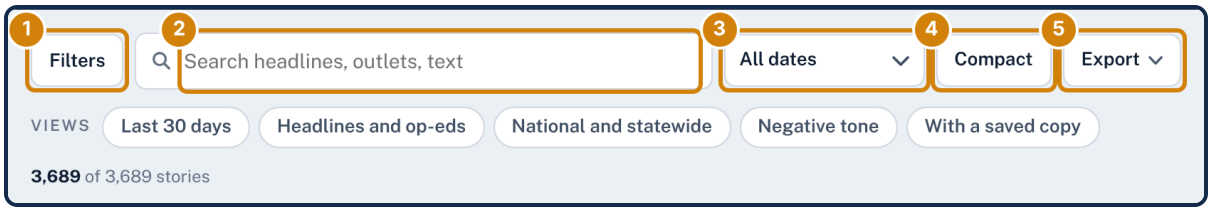
“Tone, last 90 days”, further down Home.

- **Tone, last 90 days** shows the share of positive (green), neutral (gray) and negative (red) stories. **See rated clips** lists them.

TAB 2

Clips: finding stories

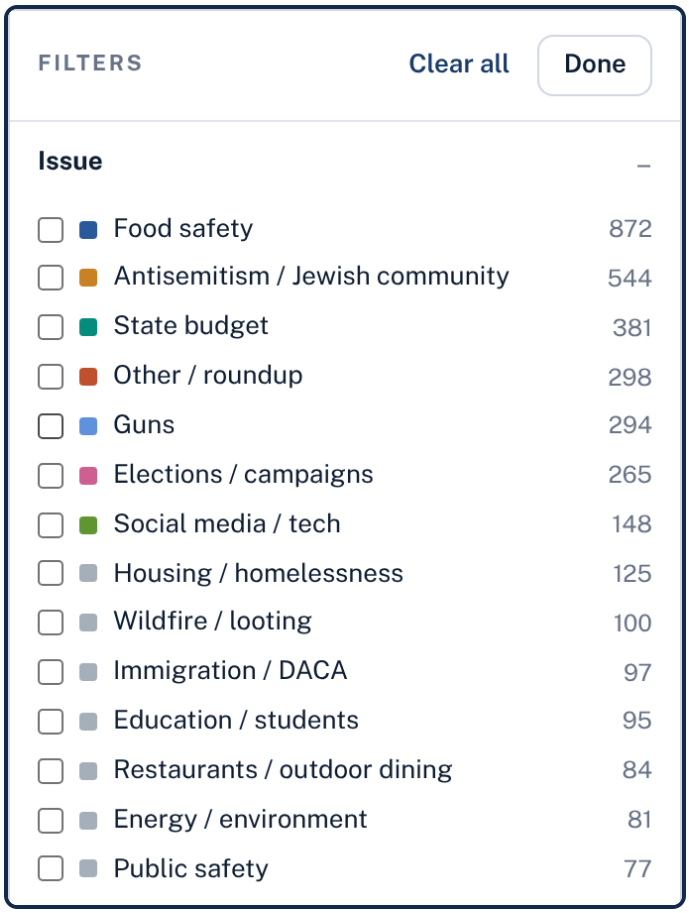
Clips is the full list of stories, newest first. Use the tools at the top to narrow it down.



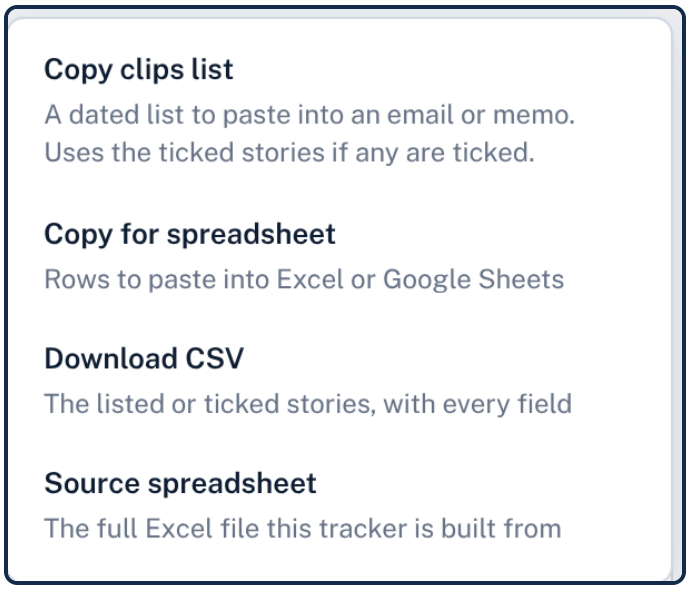
The Clips tools. The numbers match the list below.

1. **Filters.** Opens a panel of filters, one group per heading (issue, bills, reach, outlet, reporter, language, tone and more). Tick as many as you need. **Clear all** removes them.
2. **Search.** Type words from a headline, an outlet or the story text. All the words must appear, in any order.
3. **Dates.** All dates, the last 30 or 90 days, the last 12 months, one year, or a custom range.
4. **Compact.** Shows the list in a tighter layout, so more stories fit on screen. Click again to switch back.
5. **Export.** Copy the list for an email, copy it for a spreadsheet, download it as a CSV file (a simple table file Excel opens), or download the full workbook.

Views are ready-made filters: Last 30 days, Headlines and op-eds, National and statewide, Negative tone, and With a saved copy. Click one to apply it. When you set your own filters, **Save this view** keeps them as a new view button. Saved views stay in your copy only. The line under the views says how many stories match.

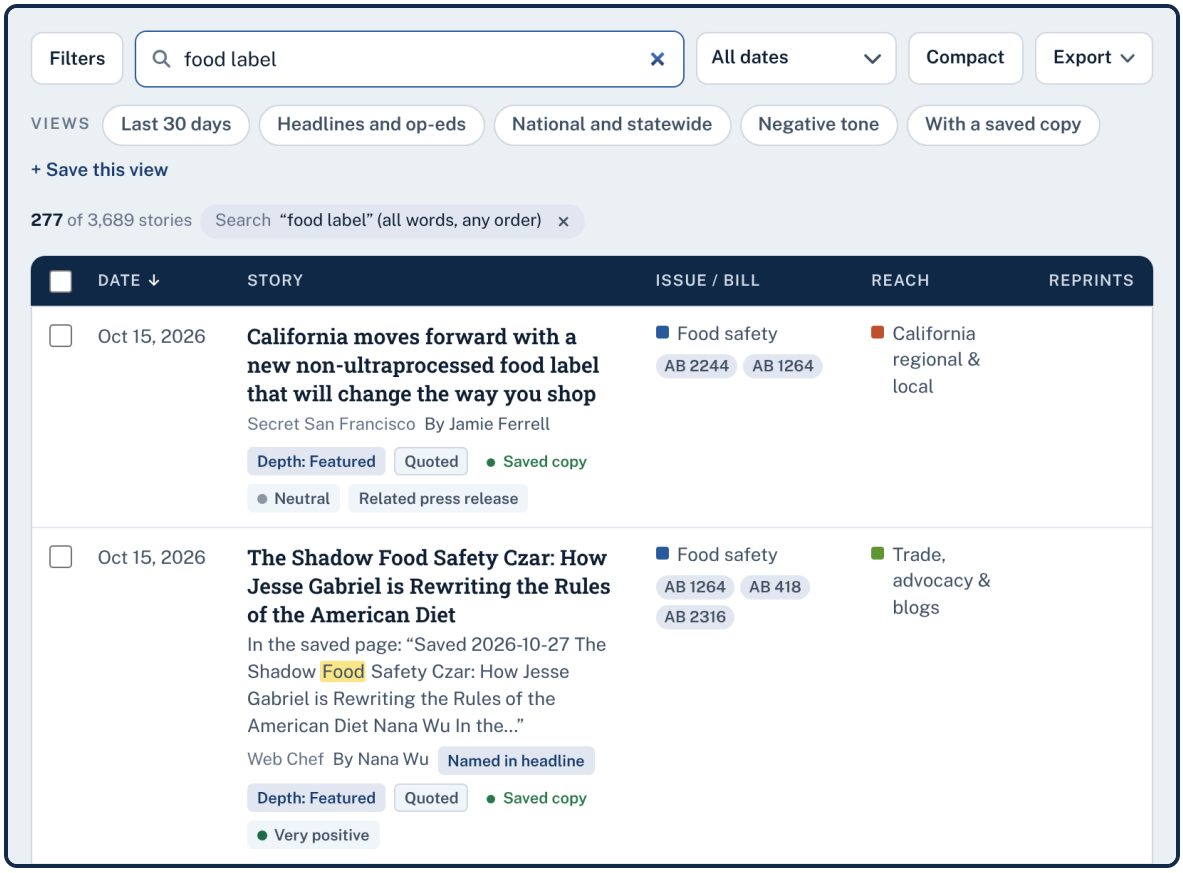


The top of the Filters panel: the Issue group. Each choice shows its count.



The Export menu.

Search results and the table



A search for "food label". The gray tag under the views shows the search; click its × to clear it. Where the words are found inside a saved copy, a short quote shows under the headline.

- **Columns:** Date, Story, Issue / bill, Reach and Reprints (how many other outlets ran the same story; see Story travel, page 18). Click a column name to sort by it; click again to reverse.
- Under each headline: the outlet, the reporter, and **badges**, for example *Named in headline*, *Depth: Featured*, *Quoted*, the language, *Saved copy*, the tone, and *Related press release*. Non-English stories show an English headline in italics.
- **Click a row** to open the story panel (next page).
- **Tick boxes** on the left pick stories. A bar appears at the bottom to copy or download just those.



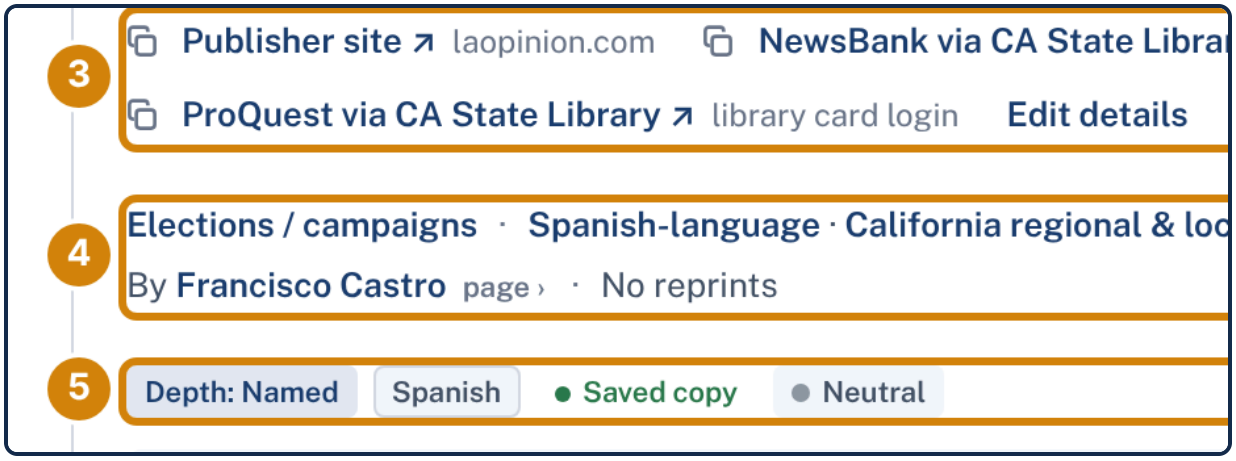
Two stories ticked. Clear unticks them.

Everything about one story

Click a story anywhere in the tracker to open its panel on the right. Press **Esc** to close it, and the left and right arrow keys to move to the previous or next story in the list.



The top of the story panel (a Spanish-language story). The numbers match the list below.



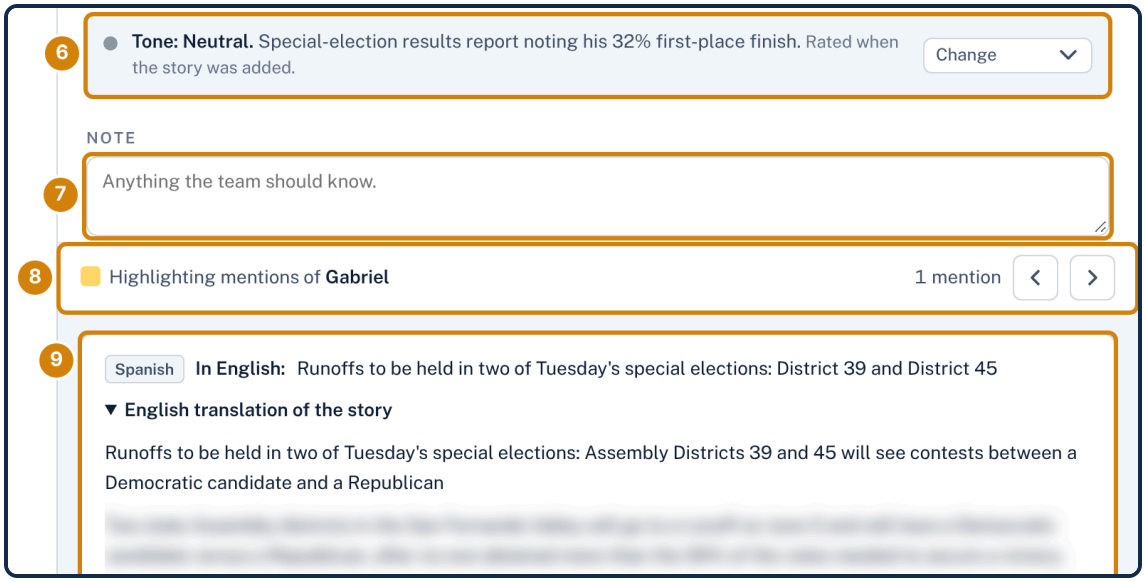
Close-up of parts 3 to 5 (left side): links, facts line and badges.

1. **Panel buttons.** Full-page view, previous story, next story, close. “1 of 1” says where this story is in the current list.
2. **Date and outlet.** Click the outlet to list all its clips; **page ›** opens the outlet’s own page.
3. **Links. Publisher site** opens the story on the news site. **NewsBank via CA State Library** and **ProQuest via CA State Library** open the library copy (you sign in with your State Library card). The small copy icon before a link copies the link. **Edit details** opens the edit form (page 11).
4. **Facts line.** Issue, bills, reach, medium, reporter and reprints. Click any of them to list every clip like it. **page ›** after a reporter or bill opens its page.

5 **Badges.** How much the story is about him (Depth: Featured, Quoted, Named or List-only), the language, whether there is a saved copy, and the tone. Click a badge to list every clip like it.

THE STORY PANEL, CONTINUED

Tone, notes, mentions and translation



Lower part of the panel. The numbers match the list below; the blurred text is the licensed article, left out of this guide.

6 **Tone box.** The tone rating and the reason for it. **Change** corrects the rating **in your copy only**; it never reaches the workbook or your colleagues. To change a rating for everyone, see page 12.

7 **Note.** A note for yourself. Notes stay in your copy of the tracker. They are never in refresh files and never in the workbook.

8 **Highlighting mentions of Gabriel.** Every mention of his name in the saved copy is highlighted in yellow. The arrows jump to the previous and next mention (or press Enter, and Shift+Enter to go back).

9 **English translation.** For a story not in English: the English headline and, when there is one, the whole story in English. It is a machine translation by Claude; check quotes against the original before you use them.

The saved copy

Below the translation box is the **saved copy** of the article, with its headline, byline and text, read from the library. For a print story, it is the PDF of the clipping. If a story has no saved copy, the panel shows the links only.

Full-page view and View original

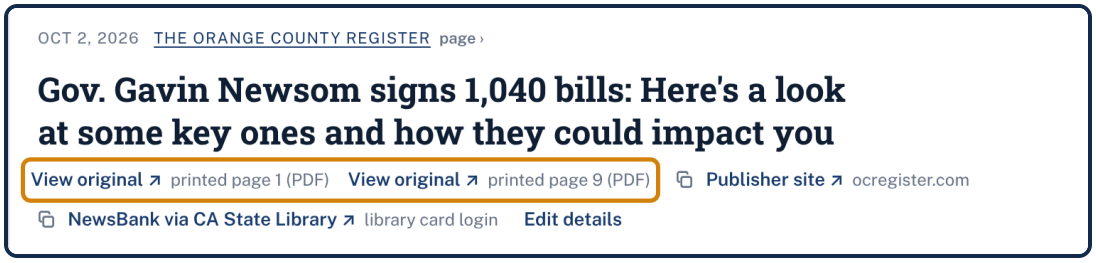


Full-page view: details on the left, the story on the right. (Shown small; nothing in it needs reading.)

The **full-page view** button (top right of the panel, the two arrows) spreads the story over the whole window: details on the left, the saved copy on the right. Click the same button again to go back to the side panel.

View original (print stories)

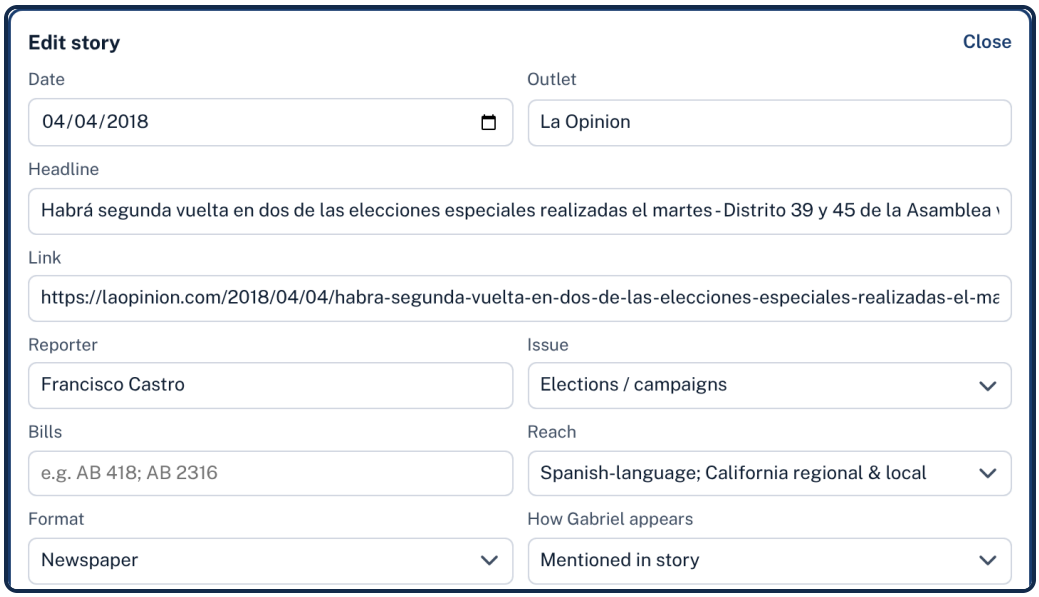
When the library has a scan of the printed page, the links line starts with **View original**. It opens the page scan as a PDF in a new tab. A story that ran on two pages has two buttons.



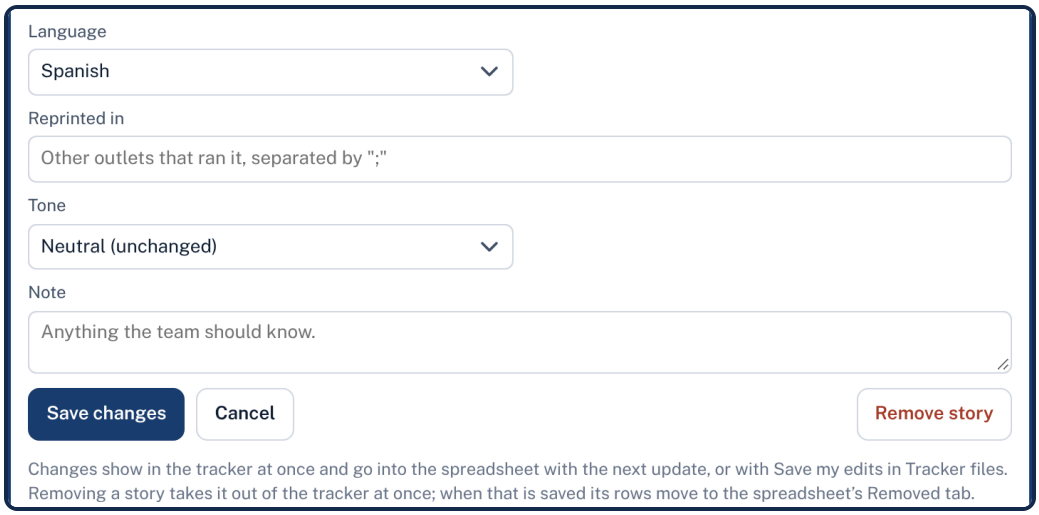
A print story with two page scans: View original, printed page 1 and printed page 9.

Edit details and your edits

Edit details opens a form with the story's fields. Change what you need and press **Save changes**. **Remove story** takes a story out of the tracker (for example one that is not about him).



The top of the Edit story form: date, outlet, headline, link, reporter, issue, bills, reach, format and how Gabriel appears.



The bottom of the form: language, reprints, tone, note, and the buttons. The gray note says: “Changes show in the tracker at once and go into the spreadsheet with the next update, or with Save my edits in Tracker files. Removing a story takes it out of the tracker at once; when that is saved its rows move to the spreadsheet’s Removed tab.”

EDIT DETAILS, CONTINUED

What happens to your edits

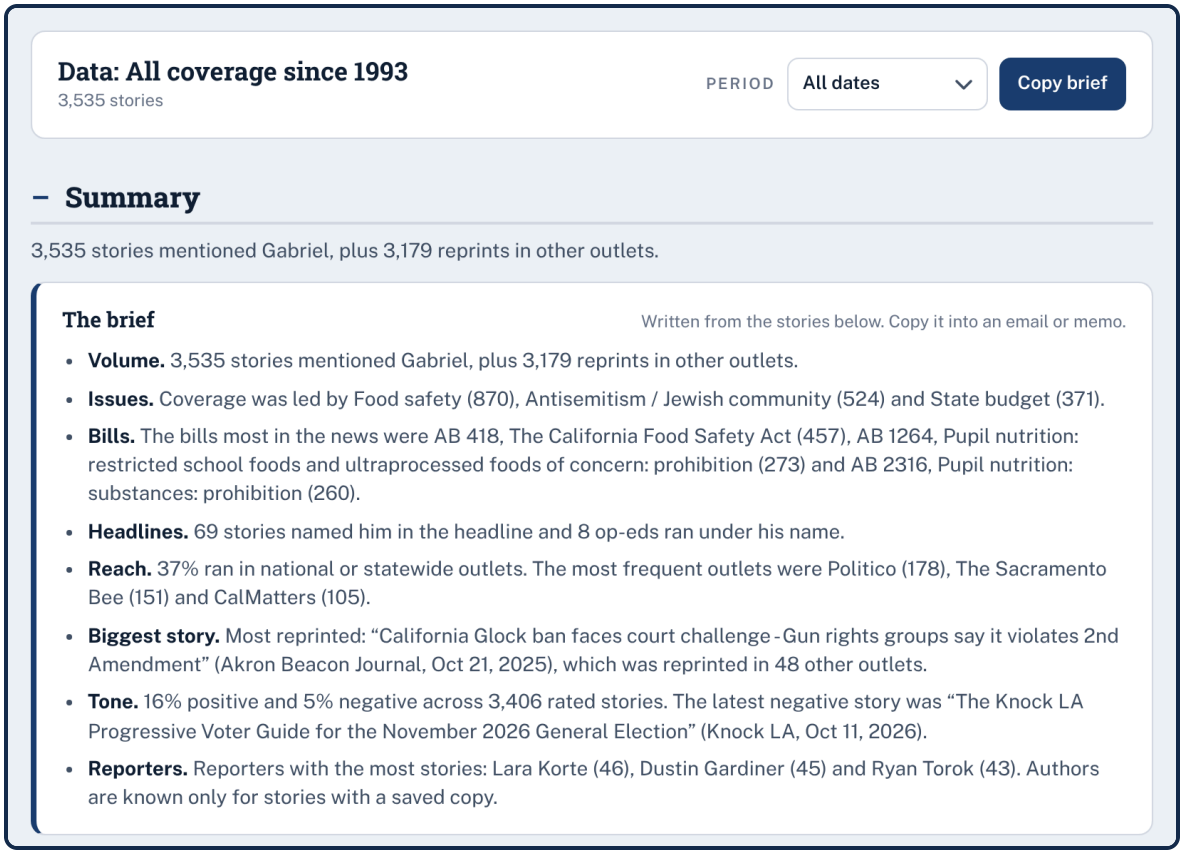
- A change shows in the tracker at once.
- It goes into the workbook with the next update you bring in, or when you press **Save my edits** in Tracker files (keeper only).
- **Edits fill empty fields only.** If the workbook already has a different value in that field, the workbook keeps its own. The preview tells you so before you save, and the change stays in your copy only. This is also true of the Tone field.

- **To change a value that is already filled in** (a wrong date, a tone rating), the keeper edits the workbook in Excel, closes Excel, and then uses Repairs, “Accept the workbook as it is now” (page 27).
- A removed story is moved to the workbook’s **Removed** tab when it is saved. Nothing is deleted.
- On a reader copy, edits and removals stay in that copy only.

TAB 3

Data

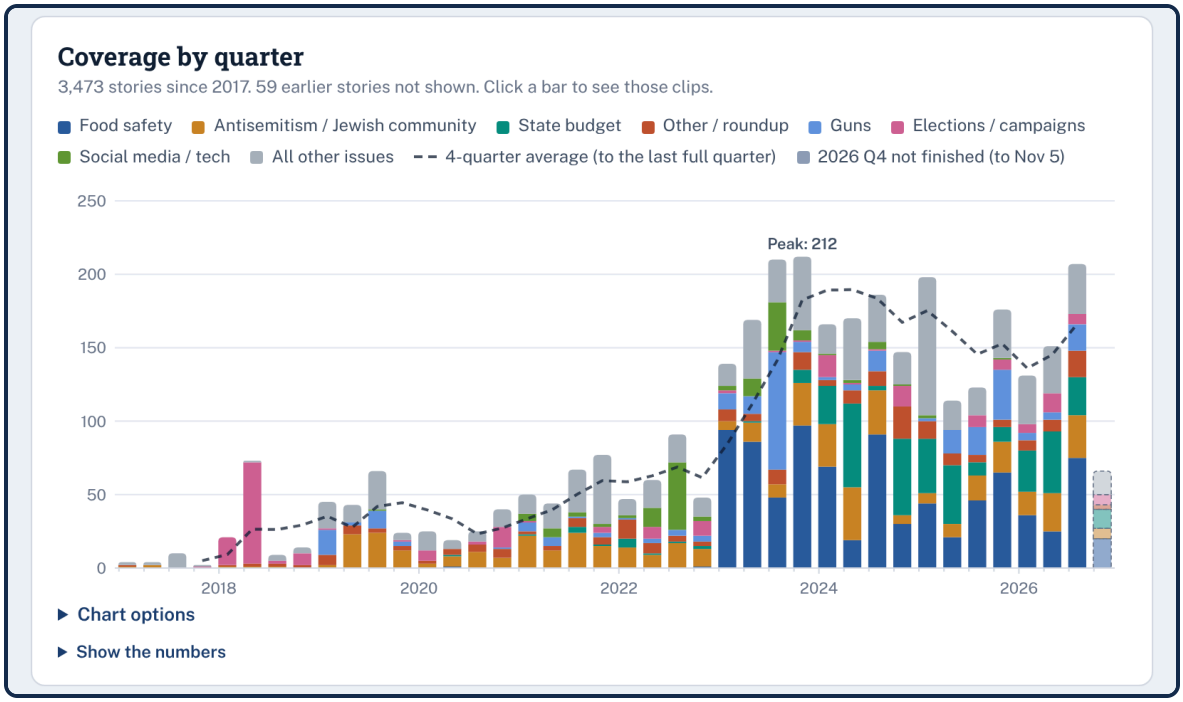
Data is the numbers page: charts and summaries for any period. Choose the **Period** at the top right; everything on the page follows it.



The top of Data: the period, Copy brief, and “The brief”, a short written summary of the stories below.

- **Copy brief** copies “The brief” so you can paste it into an email or memo.
- Click a section heading (or the – in front of it) to fold it away or open it again.

Charts and sections



Coverage by quarter. Click a bar to see the clips from that quarter. “Chart options” changes what the colors show; “Show the numbers” lists the figures behind the chart.

The sections on the Data page:

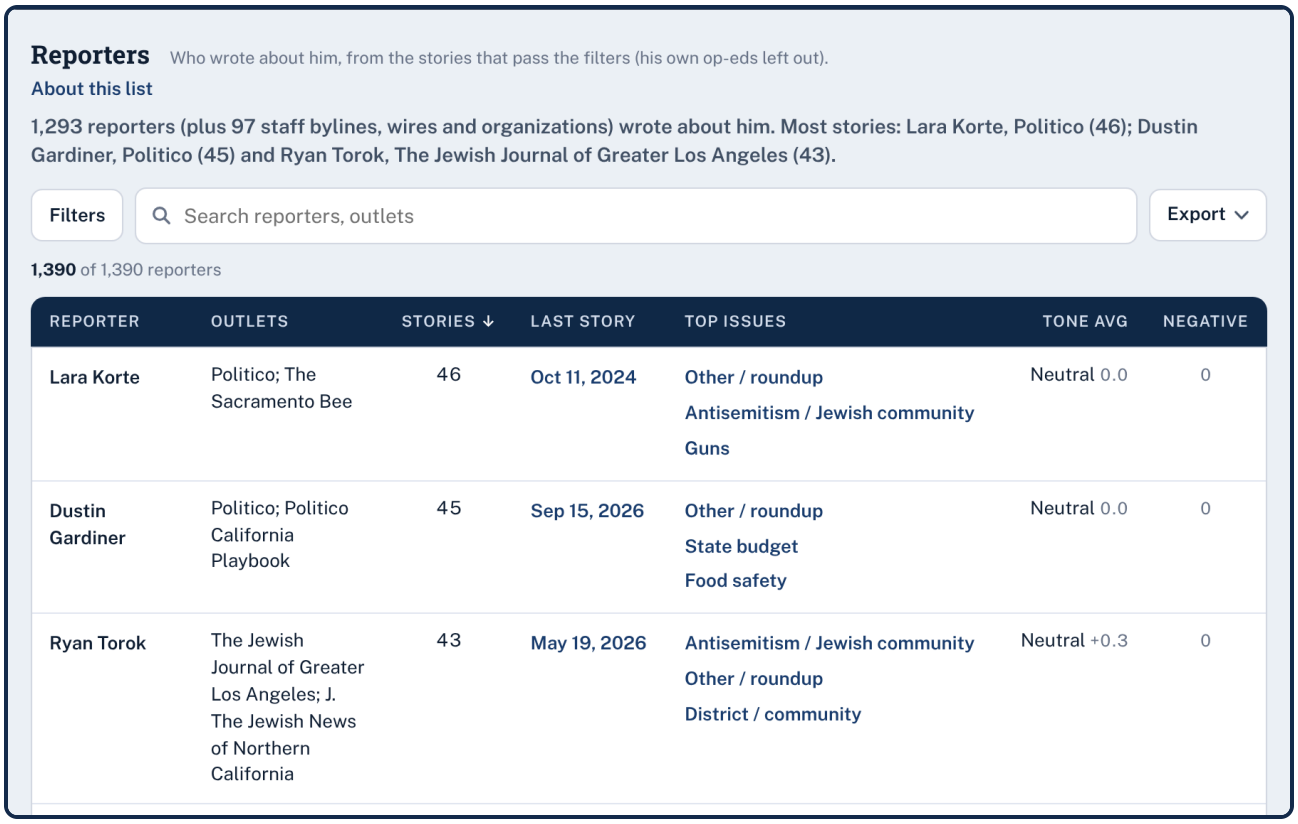
- Summary and the brief
- Coverage by quarter
- Compare two periods
- Issues & bills
- Biggest news moments
- Outlets & reach
- Reach and medium
- Local coverage by county
- Coverage outside California
- Languages
- Tone, and tone by issue
- Issues by year
- Busiest months of the year
- Bills in the news
- Top outlets
- Stories that travel
- Outlet relationships
- Gaps: outlets, counties and issues gone quiet

Wherever you see a number or a bar, click it to see the clips.

Reporters, Outlets, Press releases, Bills, Story travel

These five tabs work the same way: a short summary, a **Filters** button, a search box, an **Export** menu and a table. Click a column name to sort. Click a name in the first column to open its own page; ‹ **All reporters** (or All outlets, and so on) at the top takes you back to the list.

Reporters



Reporters Who wrote about him, from the stories that pass the filters (his own op-eds left out).

About this list

1,293 reporters (plus 97 staff bylines, wires and organizations) wrote about him. Most stories: Lara Korte, Politico (46); Dustin Gardiner, Politico (45) and Ryan Torok, The Jewish Journal of Greater Los Angeles (43).

Filters | Search reporters, outlets | Export

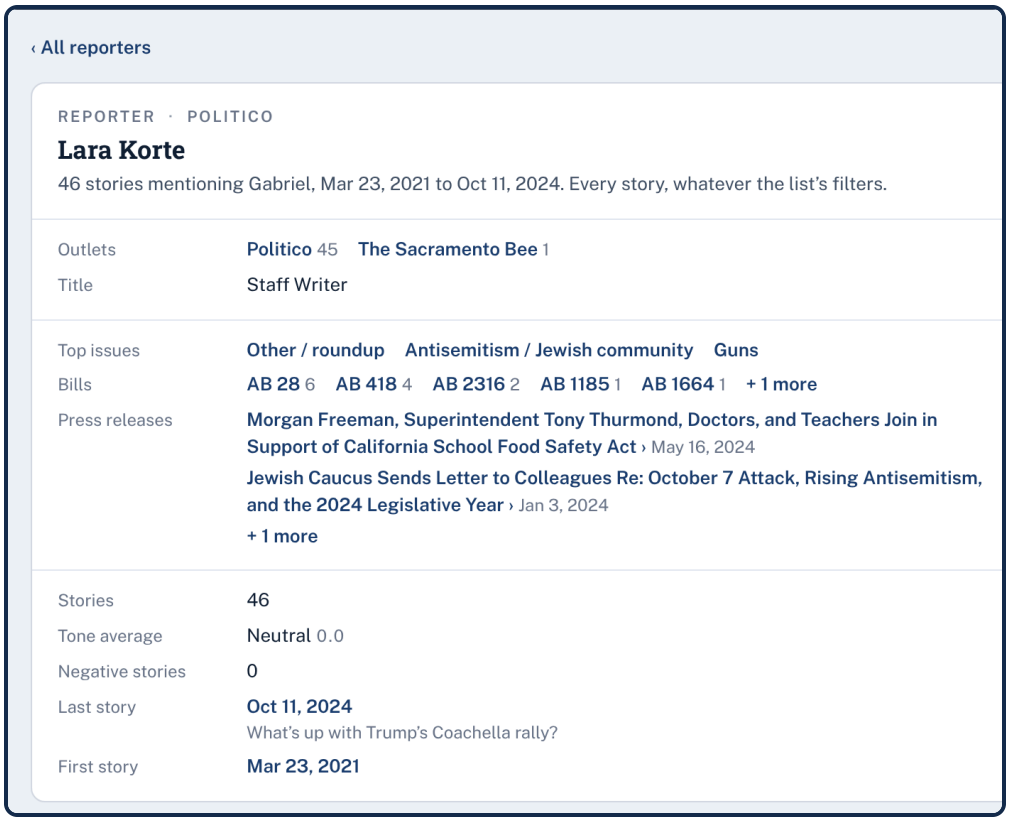
1,390 of 1,390 reporters

REPORTER	OUTLETS	STORIES ↓	LAST STORY	TOP ISSUES	TONE AVG	NEGATIVE
Lara Korte	Politico; The Sacramento Bee	46	Oct 11, 2024	Other / roundup Antisemitism / Jewish community Guns	Neutral 0.0	0
Dustin Gardiner	Politico; Politico California Playbook	45	Sep 15, 2026	Other / roundup State budget Food safety	Neutral 0.0	0
Ryan Torok	The Jewish Journal of Greater Los Angeles; J. The Jewish News of Northern California	43	May 19, 2026	Antisemitism / Jewish community Other / roundup District / community	Neutral +0.3	0

Who wrote about him: their outlets, story counts, last story, top issues, average tone and negative stories.

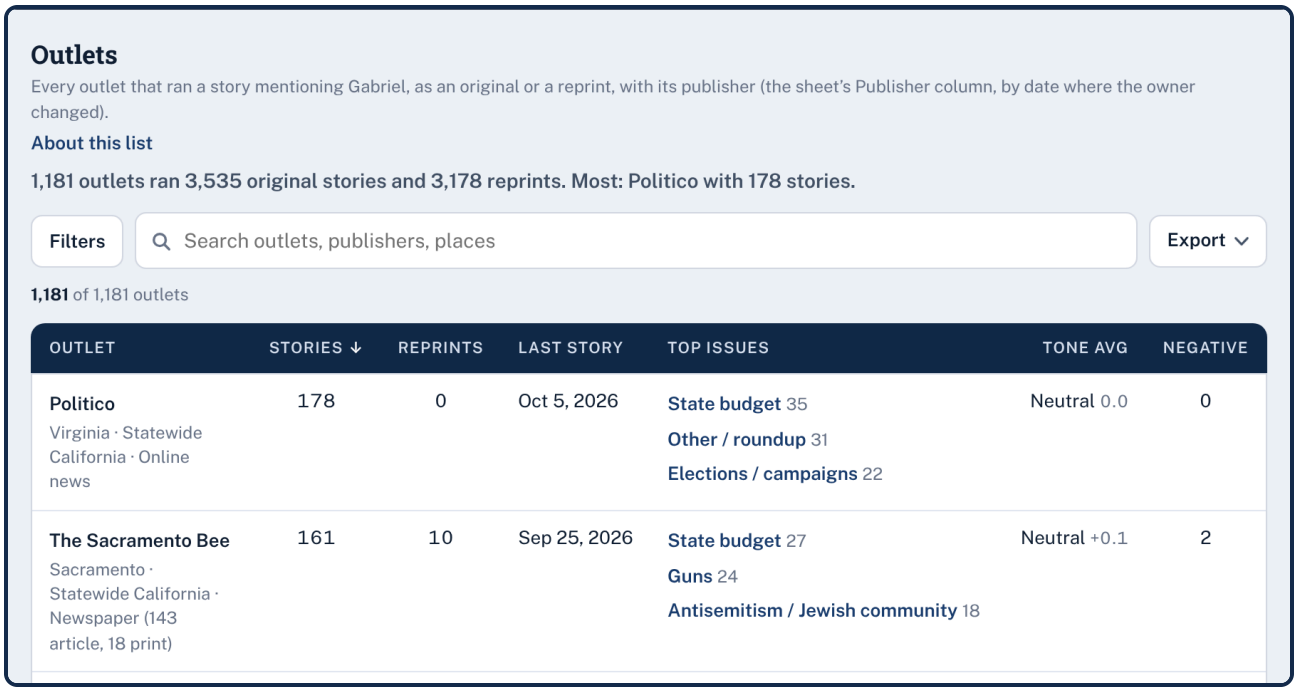
A reporter's page

Click a reporter's name to see their outlets, title, top issues, bills, press releases they wrote about, and their numbers: stories, tone average, negative stories, last and first story. Their outlets and stories are listed further down.



A reporter's page (top part).

Outlets



Every outlet that ran a story, with its place, reach and medium, story and reprint counts, last story, top issues and tone.

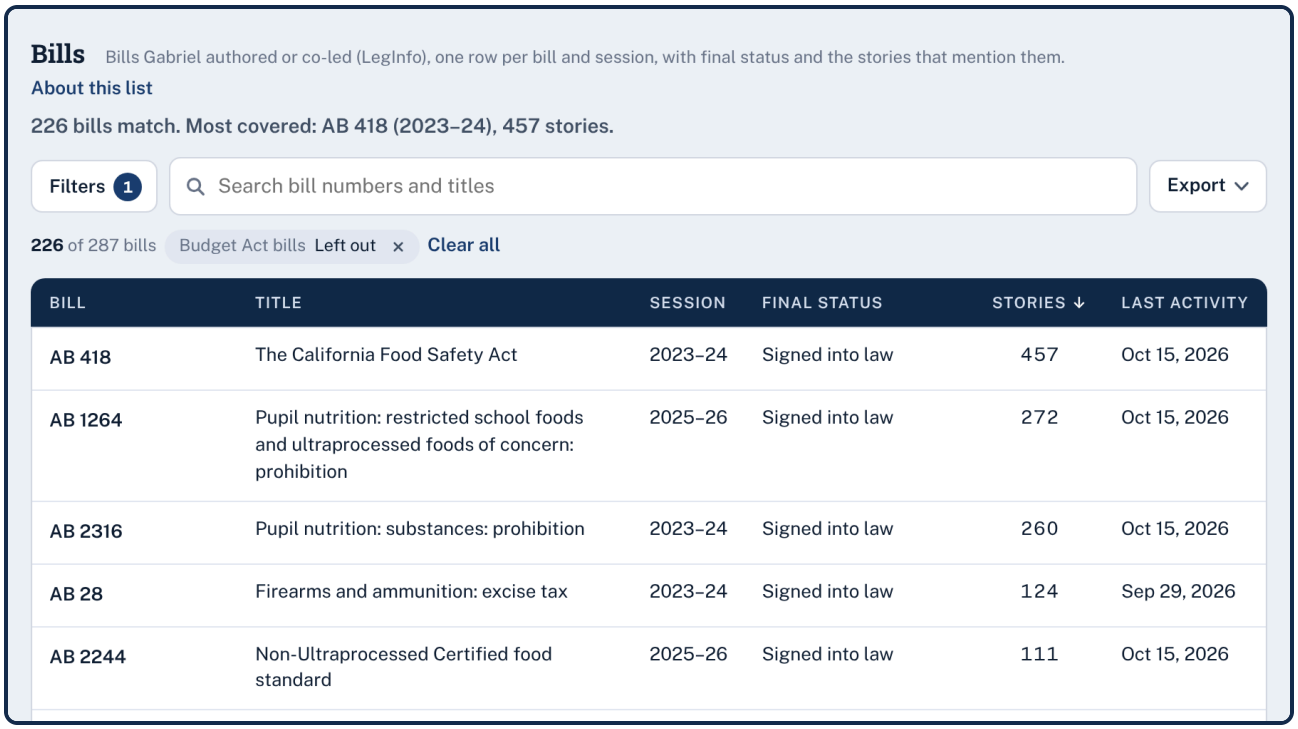
Press releases



Releases from Gabriel's office and the Jewish Caucus, and a chart by quarter. Click a bar to list that quarter's releases.

A release is **picked up** when an outlet ran its words. A release's page has **Read release** (the release text), who it was joint with, and the stories related to it: ones that ran its words and ones on the same subject.

Bills



Bills Bills Gabriel authored or co-led (LegInfo), one row per bill and session, with final status and the stories that mention them.

About this list

226 bills match. Most covered: AB 418 (2023–24), 457 stories.

Filters 1 | Search bill numbers and titles | Export

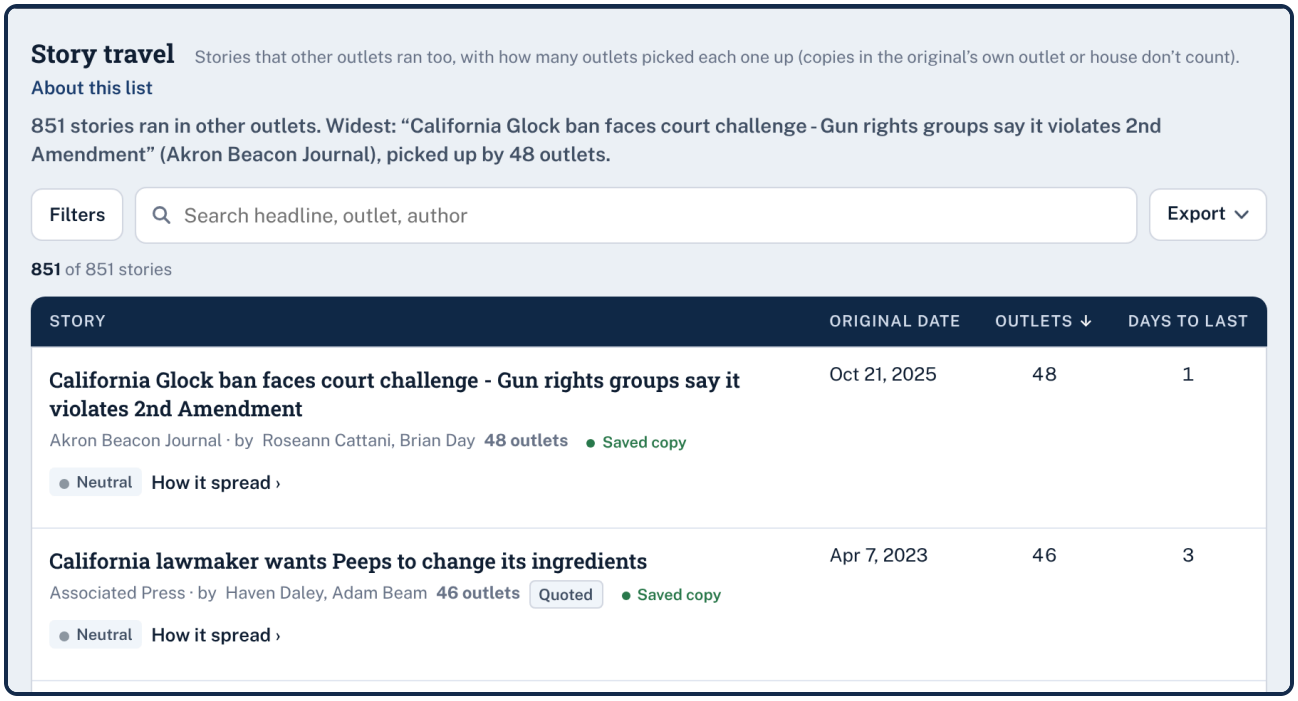
226 of 287 bills | Budget Act bills Left out × | Clear all

BILL	TITLE	SESSION	FINAL STATUS	STORIES ↓	LAST ACTIVITY
AB 418	The California Food Safety Act	2023–24	Signed into law	457	Oct 15, 2026
AB 1264	Pupil nutrition: restricted school foods and ultraprocessed foods of concern: prohibition	2025–26	Signed into law	272	Oct 15, 2026
AB 2316	Pupil nutrition: substances: prohibition	2023–24	Signed into law	260	Oct 15, 2026
AB 28	Firearms and ammunition: excise tax	2023–24	Signed into law	124	Sep 29, 2026
AB 2244	Non-Ultraprocessed Certified food standard	2025–26	Signed into law	111	Oct 15, 2026

Every bill Gabriel authored or co-led, one row per bill and session, with its final status and the number of stories. Budget Act bills are left out unless you change the filter.

A bill's page has its link to LegInfo (the Legislature's bill website), its milestones (introduced, floor votes, signed) and a weekly chart of the stories that mention it.

Story travel



Story travel Stories that other outlets ran too, with how many outlets picked each one up (copies in the original's own outlet or house don't count).

About this list

851 stories ran in other outlets. Widest: "California Glock ban faces court challenge - Gun rights groups say it violates 2nd Amendment" (Akron Beacon Journal), picked up by 48 outlets.

Filters | Search headline, outlet, author | Export

851 of 851 stories

STORY	ORIGINAL DATE	OUTLETS ↓	DAYS TO LAST
California Glock ban faces court challenge - Gun rights groups say it violates 2nd Amendment Akron Beacon Journal · by Roseann Cattani, Brian Day **48 outlets** ● Saved copy ● Neutral How it spread ›	Oct 21, 2025	48	1
California lawmaker wants Peeps to change its ingredients Associated Press · by Haven Daley, Adam Beam **46 outlets** Quoted ● Saved copy ● Neutral How it spread ›	Apr 7, 2023	46	3

Stories that other outlets also ran, with how many outlets picked each one up. "How it spread ›" opens a page with a map and a list of where it ran (not shown).

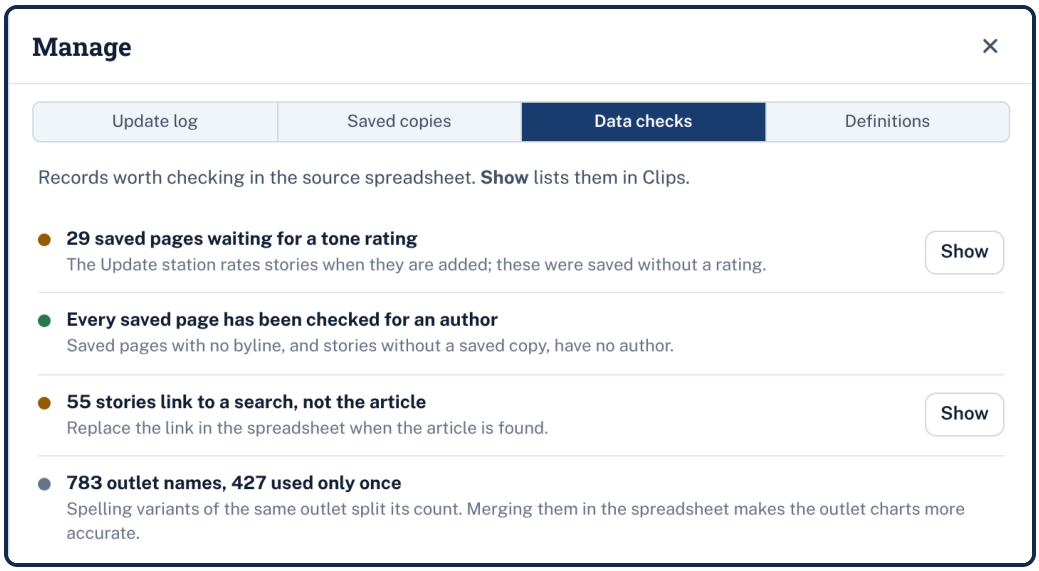
The Manage panel

Manage (top right) opens a panel with four parts. Manage and Tracker files both open on the right; opening one closes the other. Click × to close.

Part	What it is for
Update log	Each update you bring in is listed with everything it added. Click a story to open it; **Edit** opens the same form as Edit details.
Saved copies	How many stories have a saved copy. **Add saved pages** lets you add a page or PDF by hand; pages added this way show only on this computer.
Data checks	Things worth a look: how long since the last clip, saved pages waiting for a tone rating, stories that link to a search instead of the article, outlet names spelled more than one way.
Definitions	What each field means (issue, bills, reach, depth and so on) and where the stories come from.



Update log: every update and the number of stories it added, newest first. Click one to list its stories. (TinyFish is the web-search service the Update station uses.)



Data checks: records worth checking. Show lists them in Clips.

The Tracker files panel

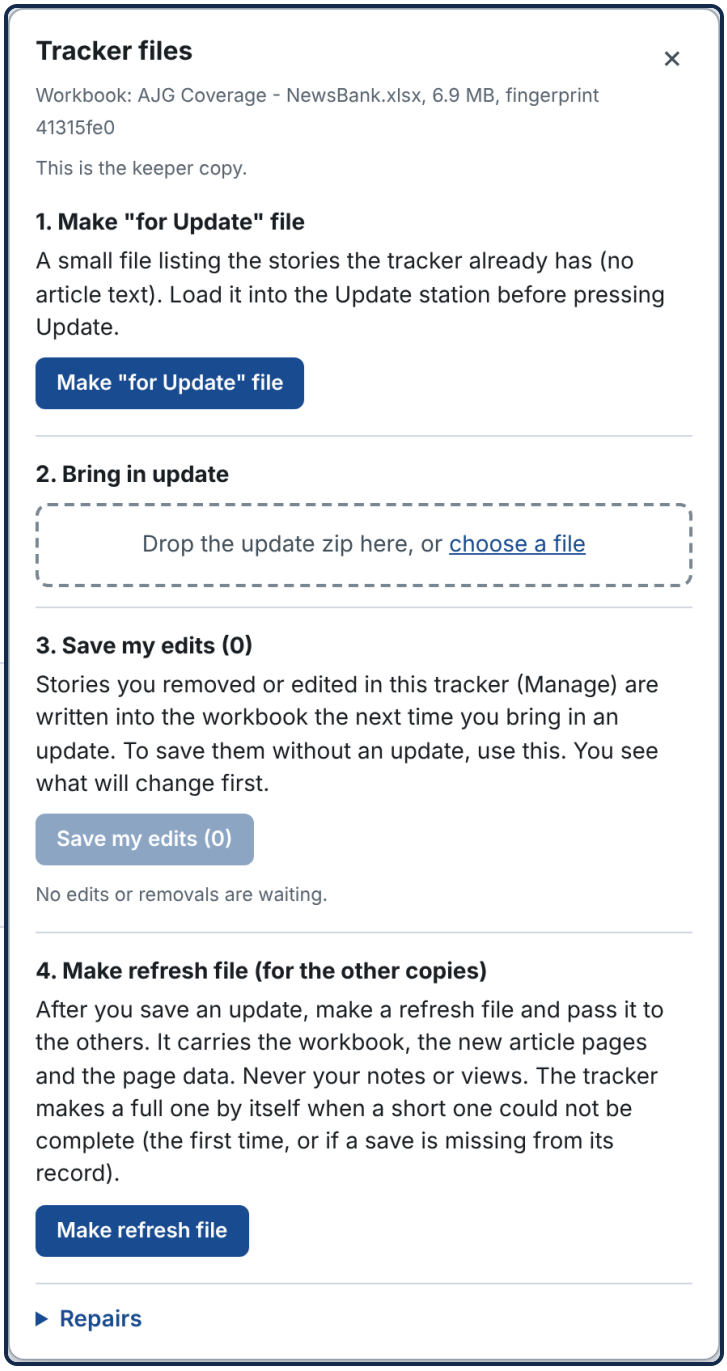
Click **Tracker files** at the top right. This panel is where the workbook is updated and shared. What you see depends on whether your copy is the **keeper** copy or a **reader** copy; the panel says which near the top.

The four parts

1. **Make “for Update” file.** Before each Update station run.
2. **Bring in update** (keeper only). Take in the update folder from the Update station, check the preview, and save.
3. **Save my edits** (keeper only). Write your edits and removals into the workbook when there is no update to bring in.
4. **Make refresh file** (keeper only). After a save, so colleagues’ copies can match.

Repairs (closed at the bottom) holds steps you rarely need.

> **CLOSE EXCEL FIRST**
>
> Saving, accepting the workbook and bringing in a refresh file are switched off while Excel has the workbook open. The panel says so in red. Close Excel and the buttons come back.



The keeper’s panel. The top line names the workbook, its size and its fingerprint.

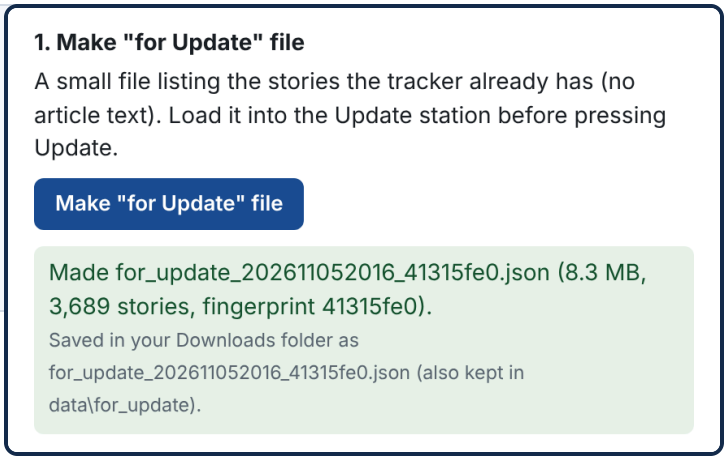
TRACKER FILES · 1

Make the “for Update” file

1. Click **Make “for Update” file**. It takes about a minute.
2. The file downloads to your Downloads folder, named like `for_update_202611052016_41315fe0.json` (the date and time it was made, then the workbook’s fingerprint). A copy is kept in `data\for_update`.
3. Load it into the Update station. The companion guide explains that part. The station runs on the office’s claude.ai account, **ajgdistrict@gmail.com**: sign in with it to open the station.

MAKE A NEW ONE AFTER EVERY SAVE

The file lists the stories the tracker has right now. A file made before a save doesn’t know about the stories that save added, so the Update station would find them again. It holds no article text.



The file was made. It is also in your Downloads folder.

TRACKER FILES · 2

Bring in an update

1. **Close Excel** if the workbook is open.
2. **Drop the update zip** from the Update station onto the dashed box under **2. Bring in update**, or click **choose a file** and pick it from Downloads. Use the .zip itself; don’t unzip it.
3. **Wait.** The tracker checks the update. Nothing is saved yet. This can take a few minutes.
4. **If a yellow warning appears** (picture below), the workbook changed after the “for Update” file was made, so stories in the update may already be in the workbook, or others may be missing. The clean fix: press **Do not use it**, make a new “for Update” file and run the station again. Only if you cannot rerun, and the only change was your own edit, press **Use it anyway**: the save still checks everything and only fills blanks, but read the preview carefully for stories the workbook already has.
5. **Read the preview** (next page).
6. **Press Save** at the end of the preview, or **Do not use this update** to drop it.

2. Bring in update

Warning. This update was made from a different version of the workbook than the one in the tracker now (update: c252cc92, workbook now: bc21c9fb). The workbook has changed since the "for Update" file was made, by a later save or an edit in Excel. Stories in the update may already be in the workbook, or others may be missing. The clean fix: make a new "for Update" file and run the Update station again. You can also use this update anyway; the save still checks everything and only fills blanks.

Use it anyway | Do not use it

The warning for an update made from an older workbook: Use it anyway, or Do not use it. (Taken before the save on page 24, so its fingerprint is the older one.)

BRING IN AN UPDATE, CONTINUED

Reading the preview

The bold line at the top sums up what Save would do. The list under it gives the details: rows added to each tab of the workbook (Coverage, Originals, Removed, Unlinked print pages), saved pages added to the library, reprint counts updated, and your own waiting edits that go in with it. The tracker compares the article texts to make the final call on what is a reprint, and gives the new files their final numbers; the preview lists every change.

2. Bring in update

If you press Save: 21 rows added, 51 cells filled, 1 rows of 1 removed stories moved to the Removed tab, 1 finds skipped (California Files, listing pages, other Gabriels or Gabriel only outside the article), 1 finds written as reprints (same text as another story), 7 dates to check (see review).

You chose to use an update made from an older workbook. The save still runs all its checks.

- Your edits made in this tracker, saved together with it: 1 story removed (s01888)
- 21 rows added to the Coverage tab
- 10 rows added to the Originals tab
- 1 row added to the Removed tab
- 2 rows added to the Unlinked print pages tab
- 4 reprint counts updated
- 2 cells of removed stories' rows moved to the Removed tab
- 2 press-release cells recalculated
- 25 saved pages added to the library
- 1 file of removed stories moved aside (not deleted)

The top of a preview. (A long list of renamed files under it is left out here.)

Items that need a person (10):

- 7 dates to check (for example: CALmatters, San Francisco Examiner, CALmatters)
- 1 possible reprints to check (for example: San Mateo Daily Journal, The)
- 1 outlets the tracker has not seen before (for example: Newtown Bee, The)
- 1 outlets with no classification rule yet (for example: Newtown Bee, The)

They are saved as they are and listed for you; the save does not decide them.

Save | Do not use this update

The end of the preview: items that need a person, then Save.

Items that need a person

Items that need a person are things the save does not decide for you. **The save writes them as they are** and lists them so someone can look later. Each line names the kind of item and gives examples (an Article ID or an outlet name):

Item	What it means
Cells where the update disagrees with the workbook	The update had a different value; the workbook kept its own. The bold line counts these as “conflicts left for the keeper to decide”.
Dates to check	The save could not confirm the story’s date. Check it against the story.
Possible reprints to check	The story may be a copy of one the tracker already has.
Outlets not seen before / with no classification rule	A new outlet; its reach and type may need setting.
Other kinds	The line says in plain words what it is, for example stories where it is unclear they are about the Assemblymember.

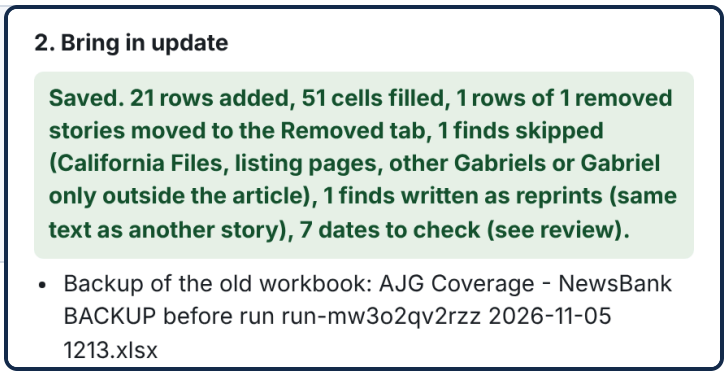
Nothing needs doing before you press Save. Afterwards, find the row in the workbook (or open the story in the tracker) and check it. If a filled value is wrong, the keeper fixes it in Excel and then uses Repairs, “Accept the workbook as it is now”. Edit details only fills empty fields.

When you press Save

1. The tracker backs up the workbook, then writes the new rows. Keep the black window open. This can take a few minutes.
2. It shows what it saved, then reloads the page by itself.

NEXT: REFRESH FILES AND A NEW “FOR UPDATE” FILE

Make a refresh file for your colleagues (page 26). Before the next Update station run, make a new “for Update” file.



After Save: the result and the backup it made.

- 0 file name(s) were as the station named them.
- 1 edit saved and set aside in the tracker (db_applied\edits, not deleted)
- New workbook fingerprint: 41315fe0
- The tracker page was rebuilt with the new stories
- 10 items are listed for a person to look at (see the run notes)

Reloading the tracker...

The end of the result: the new workbook fingerprint. (“db_applied\edits” is a folder inside data; you never need to open it.)

TRACKER FILES · 3

Save my edits

Edits and removals you make in the tracker (Edit details, or Edit in the Update log) are written into the workbook the next time you bring in an update. To save them without an update, use **Save my edits**. The number on the button counts the stories waiting.

1. Click **Save my edits**. A preview shows what would change.
2. Read it. In this example, one removed story moves to the workbook’s Removed tab. If an edit changes a field the workbook already has, the preview says that edit will not be applied (edits fill empty fields only).
3. Press **Save**, or **Not now** to keep the edits waiting.

3. Save my edits (1)

Stories you removed or edited in this tracker (Manage) are written into the workbook the next time you bring in an update. To save them without an update, use this. You see what will change first.

If you press Save: 0 rows added, 0 cells filled, 1 rows of 1 removed stories moved to the Removed tab.

- Your edits made in this tracker, saved together with it: 1 story removed (s01888)
- 1 row added to the Removed tab
- 2 cells of removed stories' rows moved to the Removed tab
- 1 file of removed stories moved aside (not deleted)

Save | Not now

The Save my edits preview.

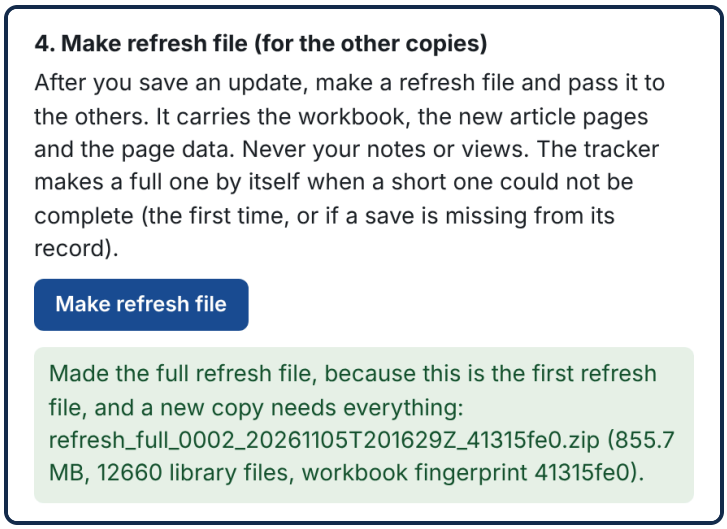
Refresh files for colleagues

Each colleague has their own copy of the tracker (a **reader** copy). After every save, the keeper makes a refresh file so the readers' copies match.

Keeper: make the refresh file

1. After a save, click **Make refresh file**.
2. It downloads to your Downloads folder (a copy stays in `data\refresh_out`).
3. Pass it on by the **shared drive, OneDrive or a USB stick**. It can be too big for email or Teams.

A refresh file carries the workbook, the new saved copies and the page data. It never carries notes or saved views. The first one is a full one with the whole library, so it is hundreds of MB (855 MB in the picture). Later ones carry only what changed. The tracker makes a full one by itself when a short one could not be complete. A colleague's brand-new copy always needs a FULL one (page 27).



The refresh file was made and downloaded. Under it the program adds: "Pass it to the others on the shared drive, OneDrive or a USB stick (it can be too big for email or Teams)."

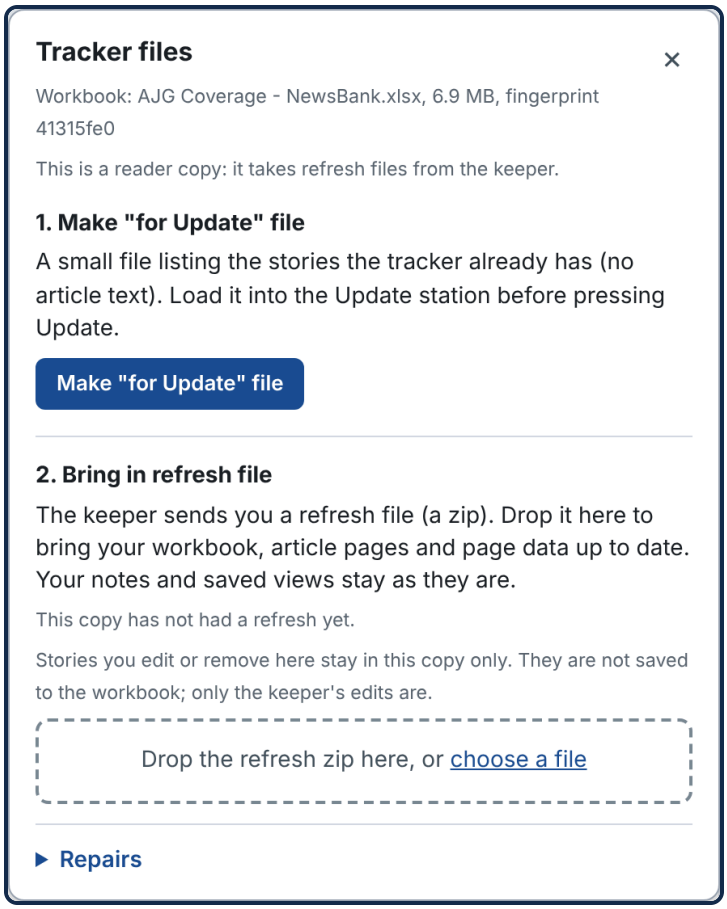
Reader: bring in the refresh file

1. Close Excel if the workbook is open.
2. Open **Tracker files**. On a reader copy, part 2 is **Bring in refresh file**.
3. Drop the refresh zip on the dashed box (the .zip itself, not an unzipped folder). The page reloads when it is done. Your own notes and saved views stay as they are.

A reader's panel has no Bring in update, Save my edits or Make refresh file. It also shows Make "for Update" file, which readers don't need.

READERS' EDITS STAY LOCAL

On a reader copy, stories you edit or remove stay in that copy only. Only the keeper's edits reach the workbook. If something needs fixing for everyone, tell the keeper.



A reader's panel.

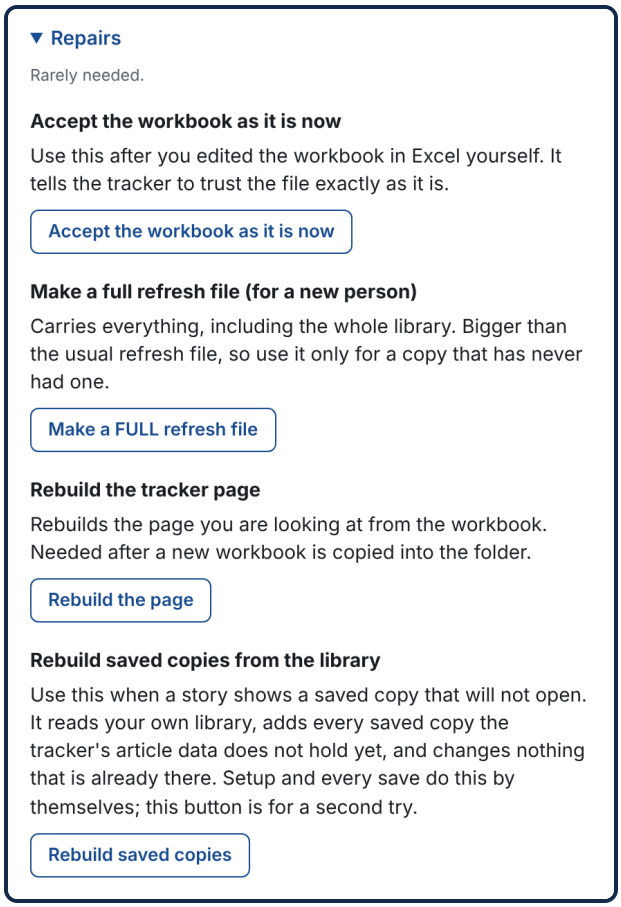
A new colleague's first copy

1. Unzip the program zip on their PC. It starts as a reader copy, with no workbook and no library.
2. Start it. The page says "No workbook yet", and Tracker files opens by itself.
3. Keeper: Tracker files, Repairs, **Make a FULL refresh file** (page 27). The normal Make refresh file is not enough for an empty copy. Pass it on by the shared drive, OneDrive or a USB stick; it is hundreds of MB.
4. The new person drops it on **Bring in refresh file**. From then on, the normal refresh files keep their copy up to date.

TRACKER FILES · RARELY NEEDED

Repairs

Open **Repairs** at the bottom of the Tracker files panel. It opens by itself when the tracker needs one of these.



Repairs, opened (the table lists the buttons).

Button	When to use it
Accept the workbook as it is now (keeper only)	After the workbook was edited in Excel (close Excel first). The tracker then trusts the file exactly as it is; until then, saving is refused. It asks “Are you sure?” first: if another person edited it, their edits become part of the tracker.
Make a FULL refresh file (keeper only)	For a new colleague’s first copy, or a copy that has never had a refresh. It carries everything, including the library, so it is large.
Rebuild the page	Builds the tracker page again from the workbook. Needed after a new workbook is copied into the folder, or when a new version’s instructions say so. Then press **Reload the tracker**.
Rebuild saved copies (keeper only)	When a story shows a saved copy that will not open. It adds every saved copy from your library that the tracker cannot open yet, and changes nothing else.

On a reader copy, Repairs holds only Rebuild the page.

NEW VERSIONS

Installing a new version of the program

When Claude sends a new version (a zip), install it like this. Your data is never touched: the new version replaces only the program parts.

1. **Close the tracker** (the black window).
2. **Unzip the new zip somewhere else**, for example in Downloads. Don’t unzip it on top of your tracker folder.
3. Open the new folder and double-click **Install update.cmd**.
4. When it asks, **drag the folder you use now** (the one with `Start Tracker.cmd` and `data` in it) into the black window and press **Enter**. Dragging a folder onto the black window types its location for you; that

is all the installer needs.

5. It checks everything first and says plainly if something is wrong. Nothing changes until the checks pass. At the end it says **Done**.
6. Start the tracker as usual. You can delete the folder you unzipped.

On a Mac: unzip the new version with Terminal (not on top of your tracker folder), run `bash "AJG Tracker/Install update.command"` from there, drag your tracker folder into the Terminal window and press **Return**.

The old program parts are kept in a `_previous_version` folder inside your tracker folder, in case you want to go back. Delete it once the new version has worked for you. Reader copies are updated the same way.

> **IF CLAUDE SAYS TO REBUILD**
>
> Some new versions need the page rebuilt once. Claude will say so. Then open Tracker files, Repairs, **Rebuild the page**.

By hand, if the installer won't run

1. Close the tracker.
2. Unzip the new version to a new folder.
3. Copy the whole `data` folder from your old tracker folder into the new folder, replacing the empty one there. With the full library this takes several minutes. Your keeper or reader setting (`role.json`) is inside data, so it comes along.
4. Start the tracker from the new folder. Keep the old folder as a backup until you are sure all is well.

YOUR FILES

Where your files live

Everything the tracker knows is in the `data` folder inside the tracker folder. Copying the tracker folder copies everything. Don't move or rename files in it by hand.

Inside data	What is there
`workbook`	The workbook, `AJG Coverage - NewsBank.xlsx`. You can open it in Excel to read it. Close Excel before you save in the tracker. If you change it in Excel, use Repairs, "Accept the workbook as it is now".
`library`	The saved copies. Year folders (`2026`, `2025` ...) by story date; `_original_html` (raw web pages); `_original_pdf` (print page scans for View original); `Press releases`. Files are only ever added, never deleted.

Inside data	What is there
`backups`	Copies of the workbook made before each save. The newest three are kept; older ones are moved to `_to_delete` inside backups.
`for_update`, `refresh_out`, `updates`	Copies of the “for Update” files and refresh files you made, and of the updates you brought in.
`db`	Your notes, saved views, tone changes and waiting edits.
`site`, `copies`, `state`	The page data, the saved-copy data and the save record. The tracker manages these.
`role.json`	Says whether this copy is the keeper copy or a reader copy.

What else is in the tracker folder

File or folder	What it is
`Start Tracker.cmd`	Starts the tracker. The only thing you open day to day.
`Install update.cmd`	Installs a new version of the program (see “Installing a new version”).
`READ ME FIRST.txt`	A short version of this guide.
`data`	Your workbook, library, backups, notes and saved views. See “Where your files live”.
`app`, `python` and anything else	The program itself and its settings (for example `layout.json`). Don’t change anything in these.

NOTHING IS DELETED

When something must go, the tracker moves it aside (to backups, to a replaced-files folder, or to `_to_delete`). It never deletes your files.

WHEN SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Problems and fixes

What you see	What to do
The black window says “The tracker did not start”	Read the line above it. If the folder is incomplete, unzip the version again, in full. If it keeps happening, take a photo of the window and send it to Claude.

What you see	What to do
“Another copy of the AJG Tracker is already running … from a different folder”	Close the other tracker’s black window, then start this one again.
“Port 8765 … is used by another program”	First look for another black tracker window and close it. If there is none, another program is using the number the tracker talks on (8765); restart the PC and try again.
The page says “No workbook yet”	A new, empty copy. The keeper makes a FULL refresh file for it (Repairs, page 27) and the new person brings it in (page 27). A keeper copy is set up from the Mac library (see READ ME FIRST.txt).
“Another save is running (… minutes so far)”	Wait for it to finish. If it never ends, the tracker stops it by itself and says so.
The tracker says the update was already saved	You brought in a zip that was saved before. Nothing is added twice. Use the newest zip.
The page won’t load, or a button asks “Is the tracker’s … window still open?”	The black window was closed. Start the tracker again.
An amber dot on Tracker files	Open the panel and read the colored box: Excel has the workbook open, a save is running, or the workbook was changed outside the tracker.
Save is grayed out	Close Excel, and wait for any other save to finish. If the workbook was changed in Excel, use Repairs, “Accept the workbook as it is now”.
“The workbook is not the one the tracker last saved”	Someone changed it in Excel. If that was on purpose, use Repairs, “Accept the workbook as it is now”. Until then, saving is refused.
A warning that the update was made from a different version of the workbook	The clean fix: press Do not use it, make a new “for Update” file and run the station again. Only if you cannot rerun, and the only change was your own edit, press Use it anyway.
“That is not a .zip file”	Drop the .zip itself, not a folder or another file.
A saved copy will not open	Tracker files, Repairs, Rebuild saved copies.
The page looks out of date after a new workbook was copied in	Tracker files, Repairs, Rebuild the page, then Reload the tracker.
Photos are missing in a saved copy	Newer copies load photos from the news site. The site may have removed them, or the PC is offline.

CHEAT SHEET

Start to finish

Every day

1. Double-click **Start Tracker.cmd**; leave the black window open (p. 3).
2. Find stories in **Clips**: search, Filters, Views (p. 6).
3. Click a story for its panel: links, saved copy, tone, translation (p. 9).
4. Close Edge, then the black window.

Keeper: each update

1. Tracker files → **Make “for Update” file** (p. 22).
2. Update station (sign in to claude.ai as ajgdistrict@gmail.com) → load it → **Update database** → download the folder (separate guide).
3. Tracker files → **Bring in update** → read the preview → **Save** (p. 22).
4. **Make refresh file** → shared drive, OneDrive or USB (p. 26).
5. Optional: **Save my edits** when there is no update (p. 25).

Reader: each refresh

1. Close Excel.
2. Tracker files → **Bring in refresh file** → drop the zip (p. 26).
3. First time: the keeper makes a **FULL** refresh file (p. 27).

New version

1. Close the tracker; unzip the new version elsewhere.
2. Run **Install update.cmd** (Mac: Install update.command); drag your tracker folder in; Enter (p. 28).